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Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, JULY 7, 2025 • \$4

U.S. seeks limited trade pact with E.U.

As Trump's Wednesday deadline looms, deal would avert 50% tariffs

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

BRUSSELS — With days remaining before President Donald Trump's self-imposed Wednesday deadline, U.S. and European negotiators continue to haggle over a skeletal trade deal that would defer a resolution of their toughest commercial disputes.

The prospective accord, which would spare European goods the 50 percent tariffs that Trump has threatened to impose, is one of a relative handful of deals the administration is set to finalize by Wednesday.

Any European bargain might prove modest. But Trump's decision to pursue his goals by ignoring the global trading rules that American leaders helped to write marks a significant break with decades of U.S. policy.

Europe and the United States for years were aligned in support of the World Trade Organization's rules-based trading system. But as European and American diplomats jostled in recent weeks, they struggled to overcome sharp differences over the best way to settle economic disputes, organize the global economy and confront a rising China.

"We think this is economic madness on the part of the Trump administration. We don't believe it helps the U.S. economy. We don't believe it helps the E.U. economy. We don't believe it helps wider

SEE TRADE ON A8

Influencers cast Russia as haven of morality

'Anti-woke' visa aims to draw those fearing a moral decline in the West

BY MARY ILYUSHINA

In a brightly lit conference room of a Moscow police department, a smiling officer flanked by Russian flags and gilded double-headed eagles handed over small blue booklets to an American family of five — asylum certificates granting them the right to live and work in Russia after fleeing Texas because they felt their way of life was under threat.

"I feel like I've been put on an ark of safety for my family," 61-year-old Leo Hare said at the time. "I want to thank President [Vladimir] Putin for allowing Russia to become a good place for families in this world climate."

"In a small way it feels like I just got married to Russia," echoed his wife, Chantelle Hare, 51. "I look forward to building a future here with my family. I look forward to the opportunities that my sons will have here."

Footage of the ceremony, shared on the Interior Ministry's official media channels, was accompanied by a caption declaring that "yet another American family choose our country to live

SEE RUSSIA ON A12

In Texas county, 'we had no warning'



JULIO CORTEZ/AP

Shocking river surge quickly burst through homes, cabins

BY ARELIS R. HERNÁNDEZ, BRADY DENNIS, ANNIE GOWEN AND AARON GREGG

HUNT, TEXAS — The 750 campers were sound asleep in their bunk beds in the early morning hours of July Fourth, expecting to wake up to a day of celebrations — a fireworks show and special treats of Hershey's bars and Coca-Cola by the lake that evening.

Instead, many were awakened by the ominous crack of thunder and flashes of lightning, clutching one another in the narrow beds for comfort. Others were roused in the dark by shouts and breaking glass as their teenage counselors smashed the cabin

windows with rocks to try to pull them from the floodwaters of the Guadalupe River, which seemed to rise in a matter of minutes.

As many of the girls at Camp Mystic scrambled for safety in trees and atop cabin roofs, the adults could see that something had gone wrong at the Twins and Bubble Inn cabins, where the youngest campers slept. Water came in from two directions, the south fork of the Guadalupe River and a creek nearby.

"It made like a swirl right around those cabins like a toilet bowl," said Craig Althaus, who worked at the camp in Texas Hill Country for 25 years.

At least 78 people died in the

SEE FLOODS ON A6



JASON FOCHTMAN/HOUSTON CHRONICLE/AP

TOP: People react as they inspect sleeping quarters at Camp Mystic in Hunt, Texas. Kerr County officials said 10 children and a counselor were still missing from the camp as of Sunday afternoon. **ABOVE:** Myra Zunker searches for her missing niece and nephew along the Guadalupe River on Sunday.

The victims: Among those killed were children and camp directors. **A7**

Nats' changes must be a rethinking, not a reshuffling



Barry Svrluga

The most shocking part about the Washington Nationals' decision to fire longtime general manager Mike Rizzo and manager Dave Martinez — stewards of both a World Series winner and a franchise that has spent a half-decade since lagging behind the rest of Major League Baseball — is that it represented active engagement and decision-making by the ownership of the Lerner family. Now, the hard part: Who's next in each of those positions, and what do those choices say about the direction of a tattered franchise going forward?

It's worth parsing the records of Rizzo, a Nationals employee since 2006 and the head of baseball operations since 2009, and Martinez, the longest-serving manager since baseball returned to the nation's capital two decades ago. Both have strengths and weaknesses, and we'll get to them.

But this crossroads for baseball in Washington is unlike any since the Lerner's assumed ownership of what had been a



JOHN MCDONNELL/THE WASHINGTON POST

Longtime general manager Mike Rizzo, left, and manager Dave Martinez led the Nationals to their lone World Series title in 2019.

vagabond franchise in 2006. In order, they have provided the infrastructure to build an annual contender that eventually produced a champion, stripped that franchise to the studs, said they were exploring a sale of the team, said they were *not* exploring a sale, and provided scant funding — not just on payroll for the big league club

but in resources and personnel up and down the entire organization. Add it all up, and since the World Series championship of 2019, only one team in baseball has lost more games.

That, apparently, is too much to take. Finally.

For this to be a genuine pivot point and not just a shuffling of

the deck, it will require a rethinking of how this entire operation runs. The inability to draft and develop homegrown players is on Rizzo and his staff. The lack of improvement by so many of his players — boneheaded base running, sloppy fielding, repeated mistakes on the mound — is on Martinez and *his* staff. It all is at the feet of the Lerner's, who now must reshape how they have done business for the vast majority of the time they have owned this franchise.

This will be difficult. No significant decision has been made by Nationals ownership since the death of Ted Lerner, the self-made family patriarch who was the Lerner's guiding light. Ted Lerner died in February 2023. Even before that, his son, Mark, had served as the club's point person. But the reality is that decisions were made by a group — Ted Lerner's sons-in-law, Edward Cohen and Robert Tanenbaum, as well as his daughters, Debra Cohen and Marla Tanenbaum. A third generation — Ted's grandkids —

SEE SVRLUGA ON A16

Inside: Rizzo and Martinez are out as the Nationals start over. **C1**

Civilians died as Israel hit notorious prison in Iran

This article is by Nilo Tabrizy, Imogen Piper, Cate Brown, Yeganeh Torbati and Jonathan Baran

The Israeli strike hit just before noon, a series of blasts that shook Tehran's Evin Prison, a sprawling complex that holds thousands of prisoners and has been a symbol of the Iranian regime's repression for more than four decades.

A former prisoner who happened to be near the complex June 23 when the rockets fell said he ran toward the explosions. As an inmate, he dreamed that he might one day see the prison gates come crashing down, but what he found that day was nightmarish, he told The Washington Post.

"Everything was rubble," said the man, who like others interviewed for this article spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of reprisals from authorities. "It was really like complete chaos and apocalypse."

SEE RECONSTRUCTION ON A11

IN THE NEWS

Musk's party The world's richest man said he has started a new political organization, but it will face obstacles including a winner-take-all system and his own temperament. **A8**

Growing pains As the WNBA's popularity explodes, longtime fans fear a shift toward a more tribal, toxic atmosphere. **C1**

THE NATION Democrats are urgently recruiting veterans as candidates for 2026. **A2**

THE WORLD Syria's Jews, who left the country by the thousands, now have a chance to return. **A9**

Video, images and transcripts shed light on the capture of an Ecuadorian drug lord. **A10**
Haiti's vigilantes are increasingly committing the same abuses as gangs, officials and rights activists say. **A11**

THE ECONOMY An Indiana county is at the forefront of a movement to make apprenticeships a common offering in high school. **A13**

THE REGION The trial of an FBI agent accused of raping clients at his tattoo parlor is set to begin. **C7**

An artist's whimsical hand-drawn map captures the character of the nation's capital. **C7**
What to know about the special election in D.C.'s Ward 8. **C7**
Virginia Attorney General Jason S. Miyares has made education issues a key part of his re-election pitch. **C7**

STYLE These days, even Donald Trump is being called "daddy." A writer explores the history and meaning of the word. **B1**
Beyoncé's Fourth of July show was dazzling, detail-minded and overflowing with subtext, writes music critic Chris Richards. **B1**

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54270

